BUS 102 · FYIC INDUSTRY RESEARCH

Beneful

The Purina Beneful Product Line: History, Products & Marketing Strategy

Greydan Bruckner

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Client Partner: Purina US

7,300

meals the average dog eats over a 10-year life*

So why should every bowl taste the same?

*2 meals a day × 365 days × 10 years

Source: (Purina, n.d.)

Today's Roadmap

01

History

From a 2001 launch to a household name

02

Products

Dry food, wet food & treats for every dog

03

Top Sellers

The flagship products driving the brand

04

Marketing

How Beneful reaches each consumer group

Source: (Purina, n.d.)

A Brand Built on Taste, Nutrition & Variety



Launch

Nestlé Purina PetCare introduces Beneful, centered on taste, nutrition & variety

Tailored recipes

Formulas adapt to dog size & needs — like IncrediBites and Healthy Weight

Beyond the bag

Wet meals, chopped blends & treats join the dry line

Brand trust

“I Stand Behind Beneful” features the employees who make it

Source: (Purina, n.d.; “Purina Launches,” 2015)

One Brand, Three Ways to Feed

Dry Food

- Originals
- IncrediBites (small dogs)
- Healthy Weight
- Grain Free

Wet Food

- Prepared Meals stews
- Chopped Blends
- IncrediBites wet

Treats

- Baked Delights
- Healthy Smile dental chews

Formulas tailored by: Dog size | Life stage | Weight | Taste & texture

Source: (Purina, n.d.)

The Flagships Driving the Brand



Beneful Originals

The core dry recipe with real meat and visible veggies — the brand's foundation



IncrediBites

Small, crunchy kibble sized for small and toy breeds



Prepared Meals

Ready-to-serve stews owners use as a full meal or a topper

MARKET INSIGHT

Dry food is still the backbone of U.S. dog food — and more owners are adding wet food as a mealtime upgrade.

Beneful sells both.

Source: (Owen, 2026; Purina, n.d.)

Matching Products to Consumer Groups

Small-dog owners

→ **IncrediBites**

Kibble and portions sized for little mouths

Weight-conscious owners

→ **Healthy Weight**

Fewer calories, same great taste

Ingredient-focused “pet parents”

→ **Grain Free**

Real meat first, no corn, wheat or soy

Value-minded families

→ **Originals**

Affordable variety at grocery & mass retailers

Source: (Owen, 2026; Purina, n.d.)

STRATEGY 1

Emotional Marketing: The Dog–Owner Bond



Celebrates the relationship

Ads center on happy, playful dogs and the people who love them



Makes mealtime a moment of joy

Food is framed as a way owners show love every day



Speaks to “pets as family”

Owners who see dogs as family want food that reflects it

> *Dogs in ads grab attention — and the warm feelings they create carry over to the brand.*
>
> **— Schoenherr, 2011**

Source: (Owen, 2026; Schoenherr, 2011)

STRATEGIES 2 & 3

Product Proof Meets Digital Reach

Product-Focused

- Real meat as a headline ingredient
- Visible veggies you can see in the bowl
- Variety of flavors, textures & formats

Digital & Social Media

- Social posts & online video starring real dogs
- Product pages, reviews & e-commerce retailers
- 2015: employees & their dogs answer online critics

> *"After working here, there's no other food that I would feed my pets."*
> **Purina employee, "I Stand Behind Beneful" campaign (2015)**

Source: (Purina, n.d.; "Purina Launches," 2015)

STRATEGY 4

Community Engagement: Dream Dog Parks

$500K

dog park makeovers awarded through the Beneful Dream Dog Park Project

Communities vote

Public voting picks the parks that win makeovers

Local partnerships

Grants, matching donations & crowdfunding help towns build parks

Lasting goodwill

The brand shows up where dog owners actually spend time

Source: (Purina, n.d.)

Key Takeaways

History

Launched in 2001, Beneful grew from one dry line into a broad, needs-based portfolio

Products

Dry food, wet food & treats — led by Originals, IncrediBites & Prepared Meals

Marketing

Emotion, product proof, digital reach & community build loyalty across groups

Thank You!

Questions?

Greydan Bruckner

Source: (Owen, 2026; Purina, n.d.)

References

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